Nikos Vasileiadis

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Professional Summary

Software Engineering Leader with 20+ years in technology and 9 years in leadership - 4 line-managing engineers - across financial services, utilities, retail, and public sector technology. I combine architecture review and implementation with people development, planning, and stakeholder work. I give engineers ownership while challenging assumptions and connecting decisions to user and business needs. Built teams and documentation cultures from zero, and led platform modernisation alongside a company-wide rebrand.

Core Competencies

- **Engineering Leadership & People Development** - building, mentoring, and retaining remote teams with cultural intelligence; using DORA delivery data and Peakon Heartbeat surveys to inform workload and career development.
- **Organisational Design & Change Management** - navigating complex restructurings and shaping team structures that align engineering capability with business outcomes; have built the same team twice from zero.
- **Technical Direction & Platform Engineering** - architecture and PR reviews, implementation, and services supporting 15+ teams; React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Contentful, and Kubernetes.
- **Product & User Experience** - field research and accessibility at Jadu; simpler content models and editor workflows at Utility Warehouse.
- **Design Systems Leadership** - end-to-end, from open-source implementation (Pulsar at Jadu) to leading a dedicated Design Systems team at scale.
- **Commercial Engineering & Business Acumen** - six-figure vendor portfolio, CapEx/OpEx planning, and vendor ROI evaluation; working across compliance, marketing, data, and IT.
- **Regulated Industry Experience** - financial services (Leeds Building Society), multi-service utilities including energy (Utility Warehouse), and public sector technology (Jadu / Local Authorities); compliance-driven environments where reliability has regulatory consequences.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
Jul 2023 - Present · United Kingdom · Remote

- **Team Leadership, Retention & Development:** Grew to 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs - web/CMS/tracking, mobile, and design systems - alongside a Product Manager. Sustained 100% retention through three reorganisations that moved the team across three departments in 25 months; every reduction was organisational, zero voluntary attrition. Drove 3 promotions through evidence-based cases informed by DORA metrics and Peakon Heartbeat surveys; developed engineers who hadn't found the right home elsewhere in the organisation; mentored engineers who are now Engineering Managers, inside and outside the company.
- **Org Design & Strategic Influence:** Scoped and executed the team's moves between pillars during restructurings - mapping scope, aligning stakeholders, and building consensus. Negotiated skill inbound - a Senior Engineer with mobile expertise - when a mobile backlog entered the team's remit, rather than stretching the existing team thin; argued successfully against a proposal to merge the Design Systems team into another team - preserving the capability that enabled the 2026 company-wide rebrand.
- **Platform Modernisation & Rebrand (Oct 2025 - Apr 2026):** Led the CMSv2-to-CMSv3 transition alongside the brand refresh across 522 pages. Addressed inherited technical debt, updated dependencies, and developed shared components with the team. Reviewed architecture proposed by engineers and implemented selected redesigned components.
- **Programme Scope & Launch:** Raised risks early, secured temporary support through my manager, and helped defer tracking and experimentation work. Worked with engineers on scripted migration, preview access, and coordinated cutover; aligned stakeholders and transferred functionality to Acquisition.
- **Content Editor Experience:** Reduced components and acted on feedback across three marketing teams; observed fewer Slack support requests after launch.

- **Platform Reliability & Analytics Ownership:** Operate uw.co.uk against a 99.99% availability target, supporting 15+ engineering teams and 8 content teams (33 users). Responsible for six services - Contentful, GTM, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust - across 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, and 1,300+ shortlinks and redirects.
- **Design Systems (Hearth) - 20 teams:** Led company-wide adoption (15 full, 5 partial), eliminating thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort.
- **CMS Transformation (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Led a 2-month, 10-vendor evaluation and migration from a legacy CMS to Contentful on an enterprise contract. A dual-serve migration avoided disruption; three marketing teams gained scheduling and structured content. The team built a Next.js / React / TypeScript delivery platform with its own GraphQL layer for request bundling, query optimisation, and content revalidation.
- **Documentation & Upskilling:** Authored over 100 articles of technical documentation - one of the most thoroughly documented teams at UW - and closed capability gaps (e.g. Kubernetes) through self-directed learning before training the team.
- **Adaptability Under Constraints (2025-Present):** With the team at a specialist core of 2 engineers after the reorganisations, took on Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside Engineering Management - sustaining delivery across 6 platform services with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate, without losing an engineer or breaching the platform SLO.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse
May 2022 - Jul 2023 (1 yr 3 mos) · United Kingdom · Remote

- **Team Building from Zero:** Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing - no department, no processes, no documentation. Started as three - myself, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer - and delivered for a full year with a single engineer, whom I line-managed from May 2022: people responsibility 14 months before the title caught up. Grew the team to five in May 2023 and promoted the founding Associate a month later - a promotion case I prepared and drove while still Lead.
- **Engineering Rigour from Scratch:** Established a fully operational Scrum environment - structured backlog, measurable velocity, predictable delivery - filling Product Manager gaps when needed, and authored the foundational documentation that grew into the team's 100+ article library.
- **CMS Strategy & Decision:** Led the evaluation that resulted in UW's adoption of Contentful as its enterprise CMS; presented findings and audit trail to leadership - recommendation accepted and implemented.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME
Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 (2 yrs 4 mos) · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Dual-role technical leader for global brands (Adidas, MARS) - architecting frontend solutions while formally holding Scrum Master responsibilities to raise the organisation's delivery standards.

- **Agile Transformation:** Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery - measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos.
- **Global Design Systems (Royal Canin / MARS):** Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence - a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support; served traffic in the millions.

Projects: Adidas, MARS, Leeds Rhinos, Royal Canin, Zopa *(now Zopa Bank)*

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)
Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 (1 yr 4 mos) · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society - a highly regulated financial services environment - while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- **Agile Pioneer:** Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time - voluntary ways-of-working forums (off-site, cross-functional) that grew championing into a parallel Scrum Master role, then a formal Interim SM appointment (Jun-Oct 2019) to stabilise Digital Transformation alongside external consultants.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu
Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 (1 yr 10 mos) · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by Local Authorities, Higher Education, and third-sector organisations - with UX, accessibility, and W3C standards as non-negotiables.

- **Design Systems (Pulsar):** Co-created and maintained **Pulsar** - an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform, and the foundation of my Design Systems specialism.
- **UX Research & End-to-End Feature Ownership:** Owned the full feature lifecycle as one of three product-area leads (CMS, Forms, CRM) - regular on-site contextual inquiry at client organisations (Wyre, Rotherham, and City of York Councils, Greater Manchester Combined Authority, University of Leeds), field research shaping the product roadmap, and iteration from mockups through usability testing to release.
- **Agile Delivery:** Foundational hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Projects: Award-winning custom CMS for large-scale public sector institutions - open-source Interface Design System (Pulsar)

Early Career, Teaching & Consulting

Oct 2005 - Dec 2016 (11 years)

Provincial northern Greece: no tech industry to join and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway and led long before I had a title for it:

- **Freelance (2005-2015):** 40+ web projects, working with people in Canada, India, Belgium, the UK, the US, and Denmark.
- **Community (2008-2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group; organised FOSSCOMM 2012, a 350-person national open-source conference.
- **Teaching (2006-2012):** Taught adult learners and tutored a student who is now an Engineering Manager.
- **UK agencies (2015-2016):** Moved to Leeds; frontend engineering for global fashion brands (Vivienne Westwood).

Education & Executive Development

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford Oxford Emerging Leaders Programme (Blended) · Executive Education · Sep 2026-Present (in progress, first cohort)

13 weeks of live online learning followed by a three-day Oxford immersion. Developing systems thinking, stakeholder influence, strategic alignment, and change leadership through a playbook applied to a live organisational challenge.

International University of Greece - Serres Campus
Undergraduate studies in Informatics Engineering, 2007-2012 (degree not completed). Continued into full-time freelance work during the Greek economic crisis.

Professional Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026
Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023
Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022-2023
Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021
Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list - Scrum, UX, FinTech, analytics, cloud, accessibility, and more - available on the Credentials page.

Community & Leadership

Mentor, WRK digital *(Feb 2023-Present)*: Peer mentoring network spanning Engineering Managers, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code *(Aug 2023-Jan 2024)*: Supported early-career engineers entering the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds *(Jan 2019-Mar 2020)*: Revived an inactive GDG chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and technical meetups.